What is the SDLC?

The Software Development Life Cycle is a structured process for planning, building, testing and delivering software. It breaks work into phases so that teams can manage risk, cost and quality in a predictable way.

Phases

1. Planning and feasibility. 2. Requirements analysis. 3. Design. 4. Implementation. 5. Testing. 6. Deployment. 7. Maintenance.

Waterfall model

Phases run strictly in sequence. It works well when requirements are stable and well understood, but changes late in the project are expensive.

Iterative and agile models

Work is delivered in short increments. Feedback from each increment shapes the next one, which reduces the risk of building the wrong product.

Spiral model

Each loop of the spiral combines planning, risk analysis, engineering and evaluation. It is well suited to large projects with significant technical risk.